Chapter 9

Electromagnetic Waves

Problem 9.1

By explicit differentiation, check that the functions $f_1, f_2,$ and f_3 satisfy the wave equation. Show that f_4 and f_5 do not.

$$f_1(z,t) = Ae^{-b(z-vt)^2}$$
$$f_2(z,t) = A\sin[b(z-vt)]$$
$$f_3(z,t) = \frac{A}{b(z-vt)^2+1}$$
$$f_4(z,t) = Ae^{-b(bz^2+vt)}$$
$$f_5(z,t) = A\sin(bz)\cos(bvt)^3$$

Solution:

The wave equation is

$$\frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial z^2} = \frac{1}{v^2}\frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial t^2}.$$

f_1:

$$\frac{\partial f_1}{\partial z} = -2bA(z-vt)e^{-b(z-vt)^2}, \quad \frac{\partial^2 f_1}{\partial z^2} = 4b^2A(z-vt)^2e^{-b(z-vt)^2}$$
$$\frac{\partial f_1}{\partial t} = 2vbA(z-vt)e^{-b(z-vt)^2}, \quad \frac{\partial^2 f_1}{\partial t^2} = 4v^2b^2A(z-vt)^2e^{-b(z-vt)^2}$$

$$\frac{\partial^2 f_1}{\partial z^2} = \frac{1}{v^2}\frac{\partial^2 f_1}{\partial t^2}$$
$$\downarrow$$
$$4b^2A(z-vt)^2e^{-b(z-vt)^2} = \frac{1}{v^2}4v^2b^2A(z-vt)^2e^{-b(z-vt)^2}\checkmark$$

f_2:

$$\frac{\partial f_2}{\partial z} = bA\cos[b(z-vt)], \qquad \frac{\partial^2 f_2}{\partial z^2} = -b^2 A\sin[b(z-vt)]$$
$$\frac{\partial f_2}{\partial t} = -vbA\cos[b(z-vt)], \qquad \frac{\partial^2 f_2}{\partial t^2} = -v^2b^2 A\sin[b(z-vt)]$$

$$\frac{\partial^2 f_2}{\partial z^2} = \frac{1}{v^2}\frac{\partial^2 f_2}{\partial t^2}$$
$$\downarrow$$
$$-b^2 A\sin[b(z-vt)] = -\frac{1}{v^2}v^2b^2 A\sin[b(z-vt)]\checkmark$$

f_3 using quotient rule:

$$\frac{\partial f_3}{\partial z} = \frac{-2bA(z-vt)}{(b(z-vt)^2+1)^2}$$
$$\frac{\partial^2 f_3}{\partial z^2} = \frac{-2bA}{(b(z-vt)^2+1)^2} - \frac{-2bA(z-vt)2(b(z-vt)^2+1)(2b(z-vt))}{(b(z-vt)^2+1)^4} =$$
$$= \frac{-2bA}{(b(z-vt)^2+1)^2} + \frac{8b^2A(z-vt)^2}{(b(z-vt)^2+1)^3}$$
$$\frac{\partial f_3}{\partial t} = \frac{2bvA(z-vt)}{(b(z-vt)^2+1)^2}$$
$$\frac{\partial^2 f_3}{\partial t^2} = \frac{-2bv^2A}{(b(z-vt)^2+1)^2} - \frac{2bvA(z-vt)2(b(z-vt)^2+1)(-2bv(z-vt))}{(b(z-vt)^2+1)^4} =$$
$$= \frac{-2bv^2A}{(b(z-vt)^2+1)^2} + \frac{8b^2v^2A(z-vt)^2}{(b(z-vt)^2+1)^3}$$

$$\frac{\partial^2 f_3}{\partial z^2} = \frac{1}{v^2}\frac{\partial^2 f_3}{\partial t^2}\checkmark$$

f_4:

$$\frac{\partial f_4}{\partial z} = -2b^2 zAe^{-b(bz^2+vt)}, \qquad \frac{\partial^2 f_4}{\partial z^2} = (-2b^2+4b^4z^2)\left(Ae^{-b(bz^2+vt)}\right)$$
$$\frac{\partial f_4}{\partial t} = -bvAe^{-b(bz^2+vt)}, \qquad \frac{\partial^2 f_4}{\partial t^2} = b^2v^2Ae^{-b(bz^2+vt)}$$

$$\frac{\partial^2 f_4}{\partial z^2} \neq \frac{1}{v^2}\frac{\partial^2 f_4}{\partial t^2}\text{X}$$

f_5:

$$\frac{\partial f_5}{\partial z} = bA\cos(bz)\cos(bvt)^3, \quad \frac{\partial^2 f_5}{\partial z^2} = -b^2 A\sin(bz)\cos(bvt)^3$$
$$\frac{\partial f_5}{\partial t} = -3(b^3v^3t^2)\sin(bz)\sin(bvt)^3$$
$$\frac{\partial^2 f_5}{\partial t^2} = -9(b^6v^6t^4)\sin(bz)\cos(bvt)^3 - 6(b^3v^3t)\sin(bz)\sin(bvt)^3$$

$$\frac{\partial^2 f_5}{\partial z^2} \neq \frac{1}{v^2}\frac{\partial^2 f_5}{\partial t^2} \text{✗}$$

□

Problem 9.2

Show that the **standing wave** $f(z,t) = A\sin(kz)\cos(kvt)$ satisfies the wave equation, and express it as the sum of a wave traveling to the left and a wave traveling to the right.

Solution:

$$\frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial z^2} = -k^2 A\sin(kz)\cos(kvt)$$
$$\frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial t^2} = -v^2k^2 A\sin(kz)\cos(kvt)$$

The wave equation

$$\frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial z^2} = \frac{1}{v^2}\frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial t^2}$$

is satisfied. Using the trigonometric identity

$$\sin(a)\cos(b) = \frac{1}{2}[\sin(a+b) + \sin(a-b)]$$

we obtain

$$\frac{A}{2}[\sin(k(z+vt)) + \sin(k(z-vt))]$$

which is the sum of a wave traveling to the right and left. □

Problem 9.3

Problem 9.4

Problem 9.5

Problem 9.6

Problem 9.7

Problem 9.8

Problem 9.9

Problem 9.10

Problem 9.11

Problem 9.12

Problem 9.13

Problem 9.14

Problem 9.15

Problem 9.16

Problem 9.17

Problem 9.18

Problem 9.19

Problem 9.20

Problem 9.21

Problem 9.22

Problem 9.23

Problem 9.24

Problem 9.25

Problem 9.26

Problem 9.27

Problem 9.28

Problem 9.29

Problem 9.30

Problem 9.31

Problem 9.32

Problem 9.33

Problem 9.34

Problem 9.35

Problem 9.36

Problem 9.37

Problem 9.38

Problem 9.39

Problem 9.40

Problem 9.41

Problem 9.42

Problem 9.43

Problem 9.44